

Travel With Your Service Dog

*2026 Guide — flights, cruises and borders,
without getting turned away* 



PREPARE



FLY



CRUISES



AT DESTINATION



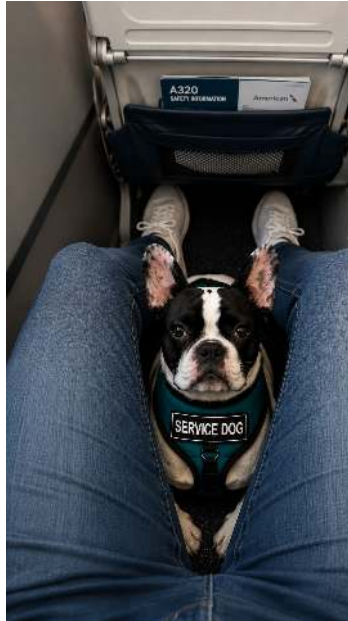
ENJOY

Well prepared, *together* anywhere.



ABOUT THIS GUIDE

Traveling should be a right, not an ordeal.



A service dog travels in the cabin, at its person's feet.

This guide was born from a simple idea: those of us who travel with a service dog do not need another training manual. We need to know how to move through the real world —airports, customs, hotels and borders— without surprises. It is all gathered here, in one place, fully updated for 2026.

It is written for the **traveler**, not the specialist. If your dog is already trained and you want to explore the US, the UK, Europe, Australia or Canada with them by your side, this guide is your map.

How to use this guide

Read it once, all the way through, before your first trip. Then come back to the chapters you need: the form, the airline table or the country checklist. Save it on your phone so you have it handy at the airport.

Important notice

This guide is informational and educational; it is **not legal advice**. Laws and airline policies change and vary by country. Always verify the current requirements with your airline and the destination authorities before you travel.

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One thing before we start

In 2021 the rules for flying with animals changed completely in the United States. A lot of the information circulating online became outdated overnight. **Everything you read here is brought up to date for 2026.**

CHAPTER 01

Service dog, ESA or pet

The difference that changes everything



Before you book a single flight, there is one distinction you need to master. Your rights, your costs and whether your dog rides in the cabin with you or travels as cargo all depend on it.

The three categories

Service dog. A dog individually trained to perform specific tasks related to its handler's disability: alerting to a drop in blood sugar, interrupting an anxiety episode, guiding, retrieving objects, providing balance. What defines a service dog is not an ID card or a vest: it is the **trained work** it does for you.

Emotional support animal (ESA). It provides comfort by its mere presence, but it is not trained for a specific task. Since 2021, US airlines are **no longer required** to accept it as a service animal: in practice, an ESA now travels as a pet and pays the pet fee.

Pet. Any other companion animal. It travels under the airline's pet policy: fee, carrier under the seat, and size and breed restrictions.

Quick comparison

	Service dog	ESA	Pet
Task training	Yes, required	No	No

Free cabin (US flight)	Yes	No	No
Access to shops / hotels	Broad (ADA)	Limited	No
Document the airline may ask for	DOT form	Pet policy	Pet policy

The 2021 change still in force in 2026

Only task-trained dogs keep **protected cabin access at no charge**. Emotional support animals are now treated as pets. If someone tells you your ESA flies free “by law”, that information is out of date.

Questions about your case?

Every trip is different. Ask **Alli**, your AI travel assistant, whether your dog qualifies as a service animal for your route and what you need to prepare. It is included in AllGo Travel.

CHAPTER 02

Your access rights

And the myths to ignore



*In the United States, two legal frameworks protect you, and it helps to know which one is in charge at each moment: inside the terminal and in shops the **ADA** (Americans with Disabilities Act) applies; on board the aircraft, the rules of the **Department of Transportation (DOT)** take over.*

What a business **CAN** ask you

Under the ADA, staff may ask you only two questions:

1. Is the dog a **service animal required because of a disability**?
2. What **task** has the dog been trained to perform?

What a business **CANNOT** do

- Ask you to show documentation, an ID card or “registration” for the dog.
- Ask what your disability is or request medical proof.
- Require the dog to demonstrate its task on the spot.
- Charge you an extra fee for entering with your service dog.
- Deny you access because of the dog's breed.

The costliest myth: online “registries” and “certifications”

In the United States there is **no mandatory federal registry** of service dogs. Websites selling “official certificates”, ID cards or registration numbers give you no additional legal rights. Your right comes from the **dog's training**, not from a paper you bought. Save your money.

When something goes wrong

If you are denied access or boarding, ask to speak with the **Complaint Resolution Official (CRO)**: every US airport must have one available, and they have the authority to reverse a gate decision. Document everything —names, time, what happened— and then file a formal complaint with the DOT under the Air Carrier Access Act (ACAA).

CHAPTER 03

The DOT form

Field by field, no fear



To fly within the United States (or to/from the country) with your service dog, almost every airline asks for a single document: the **DOT Service Animal Air Transportation Form**. The good news: it is free, you fill it out yourself, and it works for all of your trips.

Three things that take the pressure off

- **It is free.** You never pay for it on any official site.
- **It is a self-attestation.** It needs no doctor's or trainer's signature.
- **Owner-training counts.** If you trained your dog yourself, you list yourself as the trainer.

What the form will ask you

Field	What to write
Animal's name	Your dog's everyday name. There is no "registered name".
Handler / owner	Your name and contact details. If someone else travels as handler, their name goes here.
Rabies vaccine	The vaccine's expiration date and the name of the vet or clinic.
Trainer / organization	Who trained the dog. If it was you, write your own name.
Behavior and health	You attest that the dog is healthy, trained and will behave in public.

The 48-hour rule

Most airlines want the form **up to 48 hours before** departure. Fill it out once, save it on your phone, and resend it for each trip. Always check your airline's accessibility page, because each one receives it in a different way.

Mistakes that get your form rejected

- Leaving the rabies vaccine date expired or blank.
- Sending it less than 48 hours out when the airline requires it.
- Not sending it through the right channel (the airline's portal, email or app).
- Contact details that do not match your booking.

Traveler's tip

Fill the form out once, save the PDF on your phone, and re-send the same file for every trip. Bring a printed copy too — it costs nothing and can save you at the gate.

CHAPTER 04

Flying step by step

Before, at the airport and on board



A good flight is won before you reach the airport. Follow this order and you arrive calm, not scared.

Before the flight

- Book and **tell the airline** you are traveling with a service dog.
- Fill out and send the **DOT form** (up to 48 h before).
- Confirm the **rabies vaccine** is current and carry the vet record.
- Request a **bulkhead seat**: it offers the most floor space.
- Locate the airport's **pet relief areas** (post-security).
- Cut back on water a few hours before and let your dog relieve itself before you go in.

Seats: what you should know

Your dog travels **free**, in your foot space. Bulkhead rows give more room for larger dogs; emergency exit rows are not allowed. If your dog does not fit in your space, the airline must offer you another seat with room, **not deny you boarding** while seats are available.

At the airport

Inside the terminal the ADA applies: your dog goes with you to check-in, security, gates and lounges. At the security checkpoint you can go through with your dog; tell the officer if you prefer an alternative screening. Many airports offer **special assistance** if you request it when booking.

On board

- Your dog stays **on the floor**, in your space, for the whole flight.
- The airline may require a **harness or restraint** on board.
- The dog must behave: no barking, jumping or aggression.
- You are responsible for any damage it causes in the cabin.

Two rights few people know

An airline **cannot restrict you by the breed** of your service dog, and **cannot limit you to one dog** if you need two that perform different tasks. These protections come straight from the DOT rules.

CHAPTER 05

International travel

UK, Europe, Australia & Canada



*Crossing a border adds a layer: on top of the airline, the destination country's **animal-health paperwork** comes into play. The golden rule is to start early, because some requirements —the rabies vaccine above all— have minimum waiting periods you must respect.*

United Kingdom

Access rights for assistance dogs are protected by the **Equality Act 2010**. To bring a dog into Great Britain you generally need a microchip, a valid rabies vaccination and a tapeworm treatment given 1–5 days before arrival, plus an approved route. Not every airline carries assistance dogs in the cabin on UK routes, so confirm the policy before booking.

Europe (EU)

In the EU, the right to travel in the cabin with assistance dogs is backed by **Regulation (EC) 1107/2006** on the rights of disabled persons in air travel. Even so, airlines usually ask you to reserve the dog's space separately, by email or phone and in advance. Carry an EU pet passport or animal health certificate, microchip and rabies vaccine.

Australia

Access is protected by the **Disability Discrimination Act 1992**. Biosecurity for bringing a dog in is strict: you typically need an import permit, a rabies antibody (titre) test and several months of

preparation, so plan far ahead. For domestic flights, each airline has its own assistance-animal policy.

Canada

Airlines follow **Canadian Transportation Agency (CTA)** rules and accept trained service dogs in the cabin. To enter, carry a valid rabies vaccination certificate. As always, confirm the airline's assistance-animal form before you fly.

Deadlines that can ruin a trip

Rabies vaccines and health certificates have minimum and maximum dates. Some certificates must be issued just days before travel; some vaccines must be given weeks—or, for Australia, months— ahead. Confirm the exact deadlines for the country and the airline early — **do not leave it for the week of the flight.**

Golden rule for any country

Before you buy the international ticket, check three sources: the airline's accessibility page, the animal-health authority of the destination country, and, if it applies, the re-entry requirements for your home country. **Ask Alli** to build the list for your exact destination.

CHAPTER 06

Cruising with your service dog

Line by line, port by port



*A cruise is one of the loveliest trips... and one of the most tangled for someone traveling with a service dog. Every cruise line asks for different things, with **advance notice of up to 60–90 days**, and on top of that there is a CDC rule to **re-enter the US** with your dog. Let's sort it out.*

First thing to know

All major cruise lines accept trained service dogs and **none** accept emotional support animals (ESAs). What changes most between them is the **advance notice** and the **documents**.

Policies, line by line

Cruise line	Service dog	Advance notice	Key note
Royal Caribbean	Yes (no ESA)	At booking	Relief areas and accessible staterooms; “proof” helpful but not required.
Celebrity	Yes (no ESA)	At booking	On all ships except sailings to the UK (DEFRA rule).
Carnival	Yes (no ESA)	At booking	Trained working dogs only; they expect a vest/harness/ID.
Norwegian (NCL)	Yes (no ESA)	≥ 2 weeks	Requires up-to-date vaccines + USDA/international health certificate.

MSC Cruises	Yes (no ESA)	≥ 60 days	At US ports it requires US DOT documents.
Princess	Yes (no ESA)	Prior approval	"Accessibility at Sea" program; port rules vary.
Disney Cruise Line	Yes (no ESA)	≥ 60 days	Leashed at all times; import permits by country.
Holland America	Yes (no ESA)	≥ 45 days	Special requirements form at booking.

Based on each cruise line's official pages. Because these rules change, **always verify the current official page** and its date before booking.

The critical detail almost no one explains: the CDC rule

Since **August 1, 2024**, to enter or re-enter the US with a dog—including **service dogs**—the dog must: be at least **6 months old**, be **microchipped** and healthy, and carry the **CDC Dog Import Form** (valid 6 months). If the dog has been in a high-risk rabies country, you also need the US-issued rabies vaccination certificate signed by a USDA-accredited vet **before you leave**.

Boarding the ship is not the same as getting off at every port

The cruise line letting you board with your dog does **not guarantee** you can disembark at every port: each country on the itinerary has its own animal-entry rules. Check port by port before booking. This is where **Alli** shines: for your exact itinerary, it tells you which ports your dog can get off at and what you need.

Your cruise checklist

- I confirmed my cruise line's service-dog policy (and the advance notice).
- I sent the form/documents the line requires within the deadline.
- I have the microchip, up-to-date vaccines and the CDC Dog Import Form to re-enter the US.
- I checked port by port whether my dog can disembark and what the requirements are.
- I booked an accessible stateroom and asked about the dog's relief area.
- I saved everything on my phone (confirmations, forms, contacts).

Booking your cruise with AllGo

Soon you'll be able to book straight from AllGo with links to each cruise line. In the meantime, use this guide to arrive prepared and surprise-free.

CHAPTER 07

At your destination

Hotels, restaurants and transport



You have arrived. Now it is about moving with confidence. Access rights vary from country to country, but there are principles and good practices that work almost everywhere.

Hotels and lodging

- When booking, state that you travel with a **service dog** (not as a “pet”).
- Ask for ground-floor rooms or ones near an exit to the outside.
- Confirm **in writing** that there will be no pet fee for a service dog.
- Keep the confirmation email in case you need to show it at the front desk.

Restaurants and shops

In many countries you can enter food venues with your service dog. If you are questioned, calmly answer the two permitted questions and, if needed, show your **bilingual rights card** (included in the bonuses). Most conflicts are resolved with information, not confrontation.

Ground transport and apps

- In taxis and ride-hailing apps, refusing service to a service dog is usually prohibited.
- Report the driver in the app if you are refused a ride; keep a record.
- For trains and buses, check the accessibility policy before you buy.

The key

A **calm, well-presented dog** opens more doors than any document.

Extra tip

Keep one folder on your phone with EVERYTHING: DOT form, vaccines, hotel and airline confirmations, and the bilingual card. Having it a tap away prevents arguments and gives you peace of mind at any counter.

CHAPTER 08

Your travel kit

Everything that should go with you



Documents

- Completed DOT form (digital and printed).
- Rabies vaccine record and vet booklet.
- Animal health certificate for international trips.
- Bilingual access rights card (bonus included).
- Airline and hotel confirmations saved on your phone.

For the dog

- Comfortable leash and harness; ID vest (optional but useful).
- Collapsible water bowl and its usual food in portions.
- Waste bags and wipes.
- A familiar blanket or mat for the foot space.
- A basic first-aid kit and any of the dog's medication.

For you

- A list of relief areas at your departure and connecting airports.
- Airline and special-assistance phone numbers.
- Bilingual communication card to explain your situation (bonus).

- A backup vet plan at your destination.

Before leaving home: a 60-second check

Form sent · vaccine current · bulkhead seat · relief area located · dog walked. **If these five are ready, your trip starts on the right foot.**

EXCLUSIVE FOR BUYERS

Your bonuses

Tools no other guide gives you.

- Bilingual access rights card (ES / EN)
- Emergency communication card
- DOT form cheat-sheet
- Airline table: US · UK · Europe · Australia
- Country requirements checklist
- Access to Alli, your AI travel assistant

BONUS 01 · PRINT OR SAVE ON YOUR PHONE

Bilingual access rights card

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL
This is a service dog trained to assist a person with a disability.	Este es un perro de servicio entrenado para asistir a una persona con discapacidad.
By law you may only ask: (1) is it required due to a disability and (2) what task it performs.	Por ley solo pueden preguntar: (1) si es requerido por una discapacidad y (2) qué tarea realiza.
No documentation or extra fees can be required.	No están obligados a mostrar documentación ni pagar tarifas adicionales.

BONUS 02 · EMERGENCY CARD

Emergency communication card

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL
If I have a medical emergency, my service dog must stay with me.	Si tengo una emergencia médica, mi perro de servicio debe permanecer conmigo.
Contact: [your name and phone]. Vet: [details].	Contacto: [tu nombre y teléfono]. Veterinario: [datos].
My dog is trained and not dangerous; please help keep it by my side.	Mi perro está entrenado y no es peligroso; ayúdame a mantenerlo a mi lado.

Fill in the bracketed fields before printing. Ideal size: half-letter, laminated.

BONUS 03 · QUICK REFERENCE

DOT form cheat-sheet

Step	Action	Reminder
1	Download the official DOT form	Free; never pay for it.
2	Fill in the dog's and handler's details	The dog's everyday name.
3	Note rabies vaccine + vet	Current expiration date.
4	Enter the trainer	If you trained it, your name goes here.
5	Send via the airline's channel	Up to 48 h before the flight.
6	Save a copy on your phone	Reuse it for every trip.

BONUS 04 · REFERENCE

Airline table by region

Region	Typical document	Key note
US	DOT service animal form	Up to 48 h before; ESAs no longer fly as service animals.
UK & Europe	Pet passport / health cert. + advance booking	Backed by Regulation (EC) 1107/2006.
Australia & Canada	Import permit / rabies certificate	Australia: plan months ahead.

General reference; always confirm the details with your airline before traveling.

BONUS 05 · BEFORE YOU BUY THE FLIGHT

Country requirements checklist

- I checked the airline's accessibility page.
- I confirmed the destination country's animal-health paperwork.
- I verified the rabies vaccine's minimum waiting period.
- I scheduled the health certificate within the valid date window.
- I confirmed re-entry requirements for my home country (if applicable).
- I booked a bulkhead seat and notified the airline.
- I located a backup vet at the destination.

BONUS 06 · Alli, your AI travel assistant

No other guide includes this: an assistant that answers your travel questions in real time. Ask it for the list of requirements for your exact destination, which documents your airline needs, or how to prepare your dog for a long flight. Alli is built into AllGo Travel. **Turn it on at allgotravel.app.**

ABOUT US

AllGo Travel App



Luna, ready to travel.

AllGo Travel App was born from a real need: to travel with your service dog without fear of being turned away. This guide is the first step. The app goes further: it walks you through every trip with requirements by country, airline and now cruise, document reminders, and everything in one place.

Follow Luna

Share your trips and questions with us on Instagram: [@allgotravelapp](https://www.instagram.com/allgotravelapp). And if this guide helped you, tell someone who travels with their dog.

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AllGo Travel App



*Travel should be
a right,
not an odyssey*

WHAT YOU'LL FIND INSIDE



Access rights

Learn your rights and how to assert them at every stage.



DOT form

Complete guide to filling out the form without mistakes.



Step-by-step flying

From booking to boarding, without any setbacks.



International travel

Requirements, documentation and tips by country.



Cruises

Everything you need to know to travel by sea with your service dog.



Travel kit

Checklists, templates and essential resources for a successful trip.



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